

4.2.21 PCIE

Peripheral Component Interconnect Express is the latest expansion slot type suitable for graphics cards. The slot commonly used for graphics cards has 16 lanes, each carrying data at 250 Megabytes per second in one direction.

4.2.22 Polygons

Modern computer graphics define a polygon as the smallest unit of an image. Any point in 3D space is called a vertex. A polygon is any shape that can be defined by its vertices. The simplest polygon is a triangle, defined by three vertices.



The polygon model of a face

4.2.23 Rendering

This refers to the process of converting a model into an image. A model is a wire-frame representation of an object, which can have other properties associated with it, like texture and lighting information. While rendering, all this information is applied to the model to create the final picture, usually called a frame.

4.2.24 RAMDAC

Random Access Memory Digital to Analogue Converters are the chips that are responsible for converting the digital data that is generated from the GPU into analogue signals that can be output on analogue monitors (like CRTs). Since LCD monitors are digital in nature, RAMDACs are bypassed when signals are directed to the DVI port on a graphics card.

4.2.25 ROP

The Raster Operations Unit is the component of a GPU that lends the final touch to the data before it is output to the screen. Operations like Anti-Aliasing are done by the ROP. Data to be sent to an LCD monitor is directed to the DVI outputs. If